

with many factors such as health, childcare, resources and working capital limiting your ability to earn more. There is no 'right' way to work and earn as a self-employed person, which can be both freeing and terrifying. Rather than having parameters drawn for us by an employer, we have to draw our own – and sometimes that includes saying no to more money in exchange for more time or liveable working conditions. It's a tightrope act – and one where the rope keeps changing thickness at that.

I've managed, largely, to reach sense of peace with the notion of having in some way 'sold out'. For most of us, there is a feeling of conflict between our desire for change to a system that oppresses people, perpetuates poverty cycles and destroys the planet in the way that late capitalism undeniably does, and our wish to survive – even thrive – within that same system. The phrase 'money is the root of all evil' – which relates to this same system – is something that many of us have coded into our DNA, and it can make us feel anxious or ashamed about wanting more of it, even if the lifestyle that we're striving for is relatively modest. It's something that I also grapple with, but we all have to find a balance that fits with our own values, beliefs and aspirations, and I know that I'm doing that to the best of my ability. And it's none of my business whether someone else thinks I've sold out. But all of these different conflicts about the way that we work can play into our relationship with money, and distort its value and virtue in our minds, and we feel that more acutely,